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Course 201

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Research Topic: Observing the Impact of Past Warfare Ideologies and Federal Policies in Accelerating the Global Renewable Energy Focus

Title: Observing the Impact of Past Warfare Ideologies and Federal Policies in Accelerating the Global Renewable Energy Focus

Research Problem

Intense reliance on exhaustible resources, inflationary pressures and the inability to sufficiently recover from rapid global energy consumption during the COVID-19 pandemic has plunged society into a worldwide energy crisis, and renewable energy sources have emerged as a sustainable long-term alternative. However, there are substantial gaps that separate society from successfully achieving net-zero emissions. These include labour gaps, a lack of financial resources, and a difficulty transforming a world that already relies on fossil fuels as the predominant source of energy. But if we implement ideologies from the past that were used to heavily accelerate national production output, it could significantly reduce the time required to achieve global renewable energy sustainability. This research proposal aims to explore the concepts of past conflicts in extensively multiplying production levels to apply in the modern world.

Existing Literature

1.1 Past Warfare Ideologies

Past studies have revealed that notions enacted during conflict have resulted in significant yields in resource and production output. Studies have highlighted that repositioning national focuses in the U.S from civilian needs to national requirements have, with a robust administrative network, can rapidly exceed its goals in a far fewer time than it is projected to have achieved their objectives in based on their original general efficiency rate. For instance, The Henry Ford.org [1] has concluded evidence that with a centralised manufacturing focus, Ford's Willow Run plant managed to produce one B-24 Liberator aeroplane every 63 minutes during the Second World War. According to research documented by The National WWII Museum [2], because high production yields require a large workforce the U.S economy opened jobs for people of any status, including women, African Americans and most minorities, to work in positions of unskilled labour to produce both civilian and military goods. Thus, the incessant production levels and vast workforce enabled mass production to be effectively sustained. As further explained in the article, an augment in the defence budget, the introduction and sale of 'war bonds" (an approach designed to access consumer savings to support the war effort), and establishing various specialised manufacturing industries (e.g. synthetic rubber) ultimately resolved domestic shortages and advanced the GNP from $99.7 billion in 1940 to about $212 billion in 1945. All high output levels require an extensively stratified institutional hierarchy across the country. However, during the Second World War this was managed quite easily. By shifting national focus onto achieving a singular goal, one industrial policy effectively included all industrial corporations, enabling for easier cohesion among various manufacturing sectors. As detailed in the Lean Enterprise Institute [3], the U.S standardised an efficient work training program known as TWI, which involved three main training aspects: Job Instruction, which taught administrators and experienced workers how

to educate people to perform work in a formalised environment, Job Methods, which taught workers to improve current production rates by making a more effective use of people, machines and materials, and Job Relations, which taught administrators how to handle social wellbeing and problems by making a fair judgement. With this policy, all the studies have revealed that the U.S economy and the American manufacturing output exponentially increased due to an efficient workforce and a clear, centralised target, and inevitably solved unemployment and job transitioning from carbon-intensive industries.

Another clear example of how past warfare concepts have been able to accelerate such growth within months is the U.S during the Korean War. For instance, Bell et al. [4] describe how the introduction of the ODM (Office of Defense Mobilisation) controlled nineteen agencies that were able to successfully manage most problems within the U.S economy, supporting wages, production, controlling inflation levels and covering emergency situations to an adequate level. However, Jasso [5] reported that some statutes (e.g. Defense Production Act of 1950) influenced excessive spending and failed to control and account for all services involved under the statute's regulations.

1.2 Modern Energy Crisis

Past studies have highlighted that current problems with the modern energy crisis primarily surround poor financial investment and resource insufficiency. For example, Parry et al. [6] have reported that worldwide fossil fuel subsidies reached $5.9 trillion in 2020 and was predicted to increase to 7.4% of GDP in 2025. The UN [7] have examined latest data analytics and have emphasised that about $4 trillion per year would be required to be invested into sustainable energy methods prior to 2030 for society to achieve net-zero emissions before 2050. The world not only lacks this fiscal ability but the resources, manpower and technology to actively progress towards these goals. These studies underline the potential relationship between accelerated GNP growth and production turnout and the hefty requirements for a greener future.

Research Question

To what degree can previous national policies enacted during various worldwide conflicts and centralised mass production achieve in expediting the global renewable energy initiatives to fulfill net-zero emission objectives before 2050?

Methodology

This research proposal will undergo a quantitative methodology to examine the degree of effect that previous warfare ideologies and concentrated mass production can accomplish in accelerating current global renewable energy objectives to ensure that net-zero emissions are successfully fulfilled before the year 2050. Do note that the methodology considered below

will be done on the present American population before being implemented into other countries. The U.S is presented as a case study as an initial region of research.

Quantitative Aspect:

- Data analytics will compare the current progress of economic and manufacturing turnout in the past 5 years with the progress of economic and manufacturing output from 1940 to 1945 in the United States. I will be examining existing economic reports of the U.S during 1940-1945 and 2021-2026 from the U.S Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA) and the U.S Census Bureau.
- Data analytics will compare the current progress of global renewable energy objectives in the last 5 years with the manufacturing turnout from 1940 to 1945 in the United States. I will extract information and reports from the U.S Energy Information Administration (EIA) to support my findings.
- Records of data taken from economic growth and manpower will be compared from 1940 to 1945 (World War II) and 1950 to 1953 (Korean War) in contrast with projected worldwide net-zero emission rates (before 2050) and financial investment for newer technologies. I will analyse existing reports of the U.S economy, demographical data, and skill and education data from the periods of time as stated before.
- Financial growth gained through mass production and targeted national policies during WWII and the Korean War in the U.S will be compared to the financial growth of the U.S in the past decade. The monetary requirements for net-zero emissions to be fulfilled before 2050 will be compared to the remaining profit/loss as a result from comparing economic growth during WWII and the Korean War in the U.S with economic growth of the U.S in the last 10 years. This will highlight the remaining amount of money and resources that needs to be invested into global renewable energy targets if, for example, the U.S, were to apply multiple past warfare ideologies (as detailed in the Literature Review) that were demonstrated in WWII and the Korean War. Such ideologies that can be appropriated for today's purposes include targeted manufacturing, mass production and and an increase in the energy budget. This can highlight needs for improvement within any society.
- To account for the financial growth (as stated in the previous two paragraphs), I will be examining previous monetary reports and GDP figures published by the U.S Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA) from 1940-1945 (WWII), 1950-1955 (Korean War), and 2021-2026 (the modern day). This federal government bureau will provide a deeper insight into the American economy in the last century. Additionally, I will extract official reports from the U.S Energy Information Administration (EIA), a bureau within the U.S Department of Energy, who is responsible for providing statistics and analysing data on American progress towards net-zero emissions by 2050. Additionally, the Annual Energy Outlook will support my findings as it models U.S energy markets from now until 2050 in order for the U.S to reach net-zero objectives.
- Current data analytics and statistics will help survey the population for available manpower/workers to divert industries towards building new renewable technologies.

- Current data analytics and statistics will help survey present inventory reserves available in the U.S and the present supply chain management across the country to examine whether it will be able to withstand complications that may arise from diverting industries away from manufacturing consumer goods to producing newer sustainable technologies.

Ethical Considerations:

- Publicly published reports by any bureau or administration will be used
- Historical reports will only be used if it has been publicly released
- Historical integrity
- Confirmation bias will be avoided as best as possible by considering possible limitations of various sources of information
- Ensuring that reports are statistically valid

Research Topic

This topic is not a short-term problem, however if substantial change is yet to occur in the next few years, this will exacerbate the current situation. The problem of an insufficient renewable energy transition will become urgent and require immediate action as fossil fuels begin to diminish and polluted waste begins to accumulate and decay the global environment. By solving this issue within the next few years, the shift into a sustainable energy focus will be easier for the long-term.

Quality of Writing

The terminology used in this proposal is entirely academic and has been sourced from several sources of information. One thematic idea may contain evidence extracted from a variety of references. It has been written without bias or perspective and follows the requirements for a scholarly research paper. Extensive use of jargon is limited where practicable and the proposal is suitable for a multidisciplinary audience (economists, scientists, energy engineer, historians, energy analysts etc.). This proposal follows the grammar, citation, and formatting conditions strictly to fit the IARCO requirements.

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